

Unit Student Learning Outcomes (SLOs)

- Define the term 'media'.
- Identify the various media forms.
- Describe the role of the media (print, electronic, social) in raising awareness about political, social and economic issues of importance to the public.
- Explain how media contributes to the provision of the rights of information and freedom of expression in a society.
- Describe the importance of a free and independent media.
- Identify the factors which lead governments to restrict media independence.
- Describe how the media serve as a watchdog of the government.
- Identify and describe the function of the government bodies that regulate the electronic and print media.
- Identify a local issue raised in a newspaper or TV and write a letter to the editor suggesting for the government to act on it.
- Identify those aspects of the media that need improvement.
- Identify how the media can help educate the public.
- Define with examples the terms bias, stereotyping and propaganda.
- Identify the advantages and disadvantages of social media.
- Identify how the internet serves as a source of information.
- Inquire how the internet (including social media) can be used to create bias, stereotype different groups, encourages cyber bullying and suggest ways that could be used to prevent.
- Identify examples of bias, stereotyping and propaganda in the print and electronic media.
- Identify facts and opinion in news articles.
- Identify bias in an advertisement and suggest how it could be made fair.
- Identify how advertisements stereotype men and women.

Introduction to the Unit

Communicating with large number of people is called media. The media plays a very important role in raising awareness about social, political and economic issues of public importance. In a democratic country, the media plays the role in highlighting issues and needs of people. It keeps an eye on the actions of the government. Sometimes, the media is criticized for being a tool of propaganda. The media, however, need to be free from biases and it should inform report, discuss and analyze the issues objectively. We also need to become media literate. The aim of this unit is to make us more knowledgeable and skillful consumers of media.

CHAPTER 1: THE MEDIA: FORMS AND ROLES

SLOs

- Define the term 'media'.
- Identify the various media forms.
- Describe the role of the media (print, electronic, social) in raising awareness about political, social and economic issues of importance to the public.
- Explain how media contributes to the provision of the rights of information and freedom of expression in a society.
- Identify how the media can help educate the public.
- Identify the advantages and disadvantages of social media.
- Identify how the internet serves as a source of information.

Introduction

This chapter focuses on the analysis of the role played by the media. The communication channels through which news and information, entertainment, education, or promotional messages are spread is called mass media. Media includes every broadcasting (spread a message over a wide area without a target audience) and narrow-casting (spread a message over a small area to a specific target group) medium such as newspapers, TV, radio, magazines, billboards, direct mail, phones, and the internet.

Forms of Media

There are many forms of Media:

- **Print Media:** Communication delivered via paper or canvas is called print media. Examples of print media are newspapers, books, magazines and pamphlets.
- **Electronic Media:** Communications delivered electronically is called electronic media, such as, radio and television.



- **Digital Media:** Media that are encoded in a machine-readable format. Digital media can be created, viewed, distributed, modified and preserved on computers. Examples are email, websites, blogs, and internet based radio and television.



- **Social Media:** Communications through social interaction is called social media. The internet and mobile phone technologies allow users to create, share or exchange information, ideas, pictures and videos. Some prominent examples of social media are Skype, Twitter, LinkedIn, Google and YouTube.



Activity:

- Write down the features of print, electronic, digital and social media.

The Role of Media

The media perform following functions:

News and Information: It is the media that provide us with the latest news and information about events and issues in country and around the world. It keeps us up to-date on current affairs and on social, economic and political issues. It informs us about weather conditions and impending natural disasters so that we can take adequate precautions.

The media does not just present information. It also identifies important issues and points, putting them in a context so that the average reader and listener can make sense of it. The provision of information by the media in this way enables us to form opinions and make judgments regarding what we see and hear.

Education: The reach of the media is so extensive and huge, it can be used to educate people at very little cost. You can think of the media as a digital teacher, teaching thousands of students at the same time. The media offer educational programmes for children to learn the alphabet

and number as well as about their world. Programmes on science and technology, medicine and politics serve to educate adults. Special educational programmes in different languages are delivered on radio and television for special groups of people on topics of importance to them. The internet today plays a very important educational role. It facilitates people of all ages to educate themselves on almost any topic.

Raising Awareness: A very important role of the media is to raise the awareness of people about the important social, political and economic issues. It does this by providing information about social, political and economic issues and suggests ways to address them. Many social issues are brought to the awareness of the people through the media and the people then act on suggestions provided to address them. The media also provides details of all major political situations, decisions and scenarios. Hence, people can better understand their rights and make better decisions. Through raising awareness, the media help, build and improve society.

Entertainment: The media is a source of entertainment for the people. There are audio (radio), Video (TV, cinemas) and Print medias (magazines, newspapers, sports, cooking etc). The Media spend most of their resources on developing programmes to entertain (children, males and females) as a viewers, listeners and readers. However, the growing population and differences in entertainment choices, the demand for more and varied entertainment are increasing day by day. We now have the national media and the commercial media that offer different entertainment programmes to all.

Public Announcements: Various authorities and agencies use the media to spread informative messages in public. This may include warning against a storm or epidemic and delay in arrival or departure of flights and trains. In addition to these messages, the media also keep aware people about the dangerous effects of smoking and prevention of viral diseases including dengue. In some cases, for instance, it is legally binding to publish notices in newspaper like change in name, tenders and change of property ownership. In the chapter on elections, we have learned the role of media in promoting democracy and sharing update information on the campaigning process and election results.

Advertising: The media plays a very important role in advertising goods and services. Almost all business concerns use the media to sell their products. They spend huge amounts of money to advertise their product in the media. Through advertising, they create demand for their products. Advertisements encourage consumers to buy the advertised product. Thus, advertisement is the main source of income for the media.

Expression of Views: In the past, readers and listeners had few opportunities to express their views and opinions on the news presented in the media. Today, they have many more opportunities. Newspapers have had the letters to the editor sections, but now their online versions allow readers to share their views by commenting on news items. Programmes on radio and television are designed so as to encourage viewers to share their views. The internet allows readers and listeners to create and share their own ideas as well as to share their views and opinions on news.

SUMMARY

The communication channels through which news and information, entertainment, education, or promotional messages are spread is called media. There are four forms of media: print media, electronic media, digital media and social media. The media has many roles to play. The most important role is to keep the public informed through providing news and information. The media also serve to raise awareness and educate the public, provide entertainment and make public announcements. The presentation of information and the opportunity for viewers and listeners to share their views promotes the right of freedom of speech and expression.

END OF CHAPTER EXERCISE

A. Check Your Knowledge and Understanding

1. Fill in the Blanks

- i. The different channels used to communicate with others are called _____.
- ii. The use of electronic communication channels to communicate with others is called _____.
- iii. The main source of income for media houses comes from _____.
- iv. The message encoded via a machine readable format is called _____.
- v. The communication delivered in a paper format is called _____.
- vi. The interaction among people by use of internet and telephone technologies is called _____.

2. Make a Table listing the different roles of the media.

3. Answer the Following Questions

- i. Define the term media with examples.
- ii. Describe the different forms of media.
- iii. Describe how the internet performs the roles of the media.
- iv. Identify a social, political and economic issues being discussed in the media.
- v. Explain the role of media in raising awareness about these issues.
- vi. From your own experiences, share how the media help educate the people through public service messages.

B. Use Your Inquiry/Investigation Skills

1. Find out the different kinds of social media and their uses. Identify three advantages and three disadvantages of social media.
2. Develop a public service message on any current social evil or disease and display in the class or school.

C. Cooperate With Others

1. Work together in a small group of four to make the inquiry on section B.

CHAPTER 2: THE MEDIA IN A DEMOCRATIC SOCIETY

SLOs

- Describe the importance of media in a democratic society.
- List the contributions of the media in promoting democracy in Pakistan.
- Describe the importance of a free and independent media.
- Identify the factors which lead governments to restrict media independence.
- Describe how the media serve as a watchdog over the policies of the government.
- Identify and describe the function of the government bodies that regulate the electronic and print media.
- Identify a local issue raised in newspapers or on TV and write a letter to the editor suggesting measures for the solution of the problem.

Introduction

We have learnt that democracy is rule by the people or self-government. We have also learnt that the main task of democratic government is to protect the rights, interests and welfare of the people. One of the functions of the media in a democracy is to promote and protect the rights of citizens, especially the right to freedom of speech and expression and the right to information, etc.

“Article 19: Every citizen shall have the right to freedom of speech and expression, and there shall be freedom of the press, subject to any reasonable restrictions imposed by law in the interest of the glory of Islam or the integrity, security or defense of Pakistan or any part thereof, friendly relations with foreign States, public order, decency or morality, or in relation to contempt of court, [commission of] or incitement to an offence.”

“Article 19(A): Right to information: Every citizen shall have the right to have access to information in all matters of public importance subject to regulation and reasonable restrictions imposed by law”.

The Constitution of Islamic Republic of Pakistan 1973, Chapter 2.

We have further learnt that in modern representative democracies, people cannot participate directly in government so they choose from

among their people to represent them. The task of the media is to be a watchdog. This means that the media must keep a watch on the public officials in power and accurately report their actions to the public. Thus, through the media, the people are able to 'see' the role of the public officials (their representatives) in the conduct of public affairs and make judgments about them. Judgments about the performance of public officials help the people in choosing public officials and political parties in the upcoming elections.

Media can promote the freedom of speech and expression. It provides citizens information so that they can make responsible and informed choices. Through media, people can be able to ensure that the elected representative uphold their oath of office. People also have the right to complain against any TV channel that violates citizen's rights or promotes bias.

Transparency in Public Affairs

If the public is to be informed about the conduct of public affairs, the affairs of all the branches of government, the legislative, the executive and the judiciary must be conducted in a transparent manner. This means, that law-making processes and court proceeding should be open to the public. It also means that the public should have the right to information, that is, the public can request information from public officials about public matters.



Do you know?

Not only taking a bribe but also giving a bribe is **corruption**.

Free and Independent Media

For the media to perform its function to watch over public affairs and to expose poor public policy decision, incompetent administration and corruption which is noticeable in almost all affairs of public dealings. The media must be free and independent, so that it can highlight

Say No to Corruption



corruption and mobilize authorities to take action. A free and independent media means that the media, such as radio, television, newspapers or the internet, is free of government control (with few exceptions, especially for national security and harm to children), threat or manipulation. It also means that laws must protect the freedom of the media so that it can serve as a public watchdog without fear of punishment.

Responsible Citizenship

Citizens in a democracy have the following responsibilities with respect to the media:

- Use the media to inform themselves about public affairs.
- Use multiple sources of information to obtain a full and balanced view.
- Express their views and opinions on social, political and economic issues being discussed in the media.
- Raise voices against the attempts to stifle or threaten media.

Limitations on Freedom of Expression

Most expressions are harmless and are protected under the right of freedom of expression guaranteed under the constitution. However, seeking, receiving and imparting information and ideas such as incitement to violence and murder would not be tolerated by anyone. Thus, there are a few limitations to freedom of expression which are permitted under the constitution (See limitations to freedom of expression in Pakistan mentioned in Article 19 of the constitution).

Media Regulation

In order to ensure the media acts in accordance with the law, the government of Pakistan has set up the Pakistan Press, Newspapers, News Agencies and Books Registration Ordinance (PNNABRO) in 2002 to regulate the print media and The Pakistan Electronic Media Regulatory Authority (PEMRA) in 2002 to regulate the electronic media. The main function of Pakistan Press, Newspapers, News Agencies and Books Registration Ordinance (PNNABRO) is to ensure all print material is in accordance with the laws of Pakistan.

The main functions of PEMRA are to:

- Improve the standards of information, education and entertainment.
- Enlarge the choice available to the people of Pakistan in the media for news, current affairs, science and technology, music, sports, and drama etc.
- Facilitate the devolution of responsibility and power to the grass-roots by improving the access of the people to the mass media at the local and community level.
- Ensure accountability, transparency and good governance by optimizing the free flow of information.

SUMMARY

Media play a crucial role in shaping a healthy democracy. Democracy requires that citizens have the right to freedom of expression and freedom of information. The Media informs the public about the conduct of public affairs by public officials so that they can make informed and responsible choices when choosing public officials and political parties in the upcoming elections. The free and independent media also expose poor policy decision and inefficiency and corruption in the administration which helps government to take action to improve. Citizens must use multiple sources to obtain information about public affairs and must act to keep the media free and independent. Most expression is harmless and is protected under the right of freedom of expression, but there are limitations on seeking, receiving and imparting information and ideas that might endanger national security, public order or may encourage people to commit an offence. The media is regulated through government bodies to ensure whether media follow the law.

END OF CHAPTER EXERCISE

A. Check Your Knowledge and Understanding

1. Fill in the Blanks

- i. The media helps to promote and protect the rights to _____ and _____.
- ii. When the media reports on the actions of public officials, it is playing the role of a _____.
- iii. Freedom of information helps citizens to make informed choices when choosing to _____ for public officials in the upcoming elections.
- iv. The media must be _____ and _____ if it is to play the role of watchdog.

2. Answer the Following Questions

- i. What is the importance of the Media in a democratic society?
- ii. How do the media promote the rights of freedom of expression and freedom of Information?
- iii. Why media should be free and independent?
- iv. What limitations does the Constitution of Pakistan place on the right to freedom of expression?
- v. List the functions of PEMRA.

B. Use Your Inquiry/Investigation Skills

1. Watch a news programme or a talk show on television and identify the programme which serves to keep citizens informed about the government.

C. Cooperate With Others

1. Working together with your parents, list the contributions of the media in promoting democracy in Pakistan. Give at least one example in support of each contribution.

CHAPTER 3: IMPERFECTIONS OF THE MEDIA

SLOs

- Define with examples the terms bias, stereotyping and propaganda.
- Identify examples of bias, stereotyping and propaganda in the print and electronic media.
- Inquire how the internet (including social media) can be used to create bias, stereotype different groups, encourage cyber bullying and suggest ways that could be used to prevent.
- Identify facts and opinion in news articles.
- Identify bias in an advertisement and suggest how it could be made fair.
- Identify how advertisements stereotype men and women.
- Identify those aspects of the media that need improvement.

Introduction

We are all influenced by other individuals and groups (pressure group). The mass media, television, radio, newspapers, magazines and books, both inform and influence us. The information we receive can be accurate and/or misleading. We need to be aware that what is printed, broadcasted, telecast or put on the internet may be accurate and/or misleading. Therefore, while reading the newspaper, listening to the radio, watching television or accessing information from the internet, we should not jump to conclusions, but first find out more and then use our critical thinking skills to decide what to believe and to work out our own views and opinions.

There are many ways used by the media to provide inaccurate and misleading information. Below you will learn some of the ways and how to detect them so that you can decide what to believe and what to do:

Fact and Opinion

A fact is a statement about something that really happened or something you can prove. Facts can be directly observed or can be checked and are backed up by evidence. For example, "Quaid-i-Azam Mohammad Ali Jinnah died on September 11, 1948 can be verified from newspaper reports and death certificate".

An opinion is a general statement indicating a belief, view or judgment about something in the past, present or future which cannot be fully proven to be true. An opinion is not based on evidence that can be checked. For example, 'My mother is the best cook in the world' is an opinion as there is no evidence by which it can be checked.

When providing news and information, the media must present the facts. Sometimes, however, the media presents opinions as if they are facts, which is an unfair way. It is, for this reason that every person must know how to distinguish between facts and opinions.

Activity:

- Read a news article in the newspaper and identify the facts and opinions in it. Near each sentence that is a fact and has evidence or is universal truth write, 'F' and near each sentence that has no evidence or is a belief or view of an individual write 'O'.

Exploring Media Bias

Bias is a tendency to favour one person, group, thing or point of view over another, often in an unfair way. The one way of media bias is the bias of news reporters. The selection and coverage of news stories is another way of being biased against some person or group. It occurs when a media outlet (newspaper, radio, TV station) chooses only to report some news stories, but not others and when a news story is covered in a partial manner or seems to push one viewpoint ignoring the others.

How to Detect Bias?

You can detect various forms of bias in the media by asking yourself the following questions:

- **Bias by Omission:** Ask whose point of view is presented? Is the point of view of one side promoted or the point of view of all the affected shared?
- **Bias by Selection of Story:** Are stories about one side of an issue being presented again and again?
- **Bias by Selection of Sources:** Ask who are the sources? When a reporter uses such phrases as "officials say", "Experts believe," or "most people agree" we do not know who the source is? and what are their personal views or position on the item?
- **Bias by Labeling:** How are the people on both sides of an issue

labeled? Is one side given extreme labels and the other mild or left unlabeled? Is one side positively labeled and the other side negatively labeled?

- **Bias by Placement:** Are important stories featured prominently? Look at where stories appear. Important stories should be featured in newspapers on the most widely read pages (the front and editorial pages) and lead stories at the beginning of television and radio programmes.
- **Bias by Spin:** Many news stories do not reflect a particular spin, this bias is observed when a story has only one interpretation of an event or policy. It is mostly because of reporter's subjective comments about the facts.
- **Urban Bias:** Media has a tendency to present more urban culture, although our country is more rural, which has a rich culture and has a lot of moral and social practices to promote. The trend is slowly changing, but this needs more thinking and resource allocation.

Activities:

- Read the newspaper or magazine to identify the biases in the news stories covered.
- Listen to the radio or watch television and identify the biases in the stories.

Stereotyping

A stereotype is a generalization, that is too simple, usually exaggerated and often offensive; used to describe a group based on their appearance, behaviour or beliefs. Usually all members of the group are described as such without regard for individual differences. For example, "All Africans are lazy and unreliable" or "Football players are stupid."

The Media creates new stereotypes and reinforces stereotypes already existing in a culture. Some common stereotypes are as follows:

Gender Stereotyping: There are some common stereotypes of men and women, such as: Men are the "bread winners", that is, they earn the money. Women are "housewives", they stay at home. Men are the "backbone" that is they are strong and do all the work. Women are "dumb" that is they are not as smart as men.

Stereotyping Based on Race: In our country, One of the more common stereotypes surround the race is that, "A" community is feudalistic and

Common Propaganda Techniques

There are many propaganda techniques, but only eight commonly used ones are described below:

- **Card Stacking:** Presents the good or unique factors or presents the worst possible case.
- **Name-Calling:** Uses negative words to describe or label someone or something.
- **Bandwagon:** Claims "Everyone" has one. "Everyone" is doing it! etc.
- **Appeal to Emotion:** Uses information to arouse feelings.
- **Transfer:** Carries the authority or prestige of something respected over to something else in order to make it respected as well. This may involve the use of symbols to accomplish a purpose for which they were not intended.
- **Glittering Generalities:** Describes something or someone in extremely positive terms.
- **Testimonial:** Uses a famous and/or popular person to say that the idea is good.
- **Plain Folks:** Uses an ordinary person, who uses ordinary language and mannerisms to reach the audience and identify with their point of view.

Activity:

- Watch television or listen to the radio and identify the use of each of the propaganda techniques mentioned above.
- Read the newspaper/ magazine and identify the use of each of the propaganda techniques mentioned above.

SUMMARY

The news and information provided by the media may be inaccurate or misleading. Inaccurate and misleading information is often provided not to inform but to influence us. There are many ways in which inaccurate and misleading information is provided by media. Bias is a tendency to favour one person, group, thing or point of view over another. Stereotyping is a judgment about individual, group or a race without knowing individual, group or a race properly. Propaganda is the spreading of ideas, information, or rumor for the purpose of helping or injuring an institution, a cause, or a person.

END OF CHAPTER EXERCISE

A. Check Your Knowledge and Understanding

1. Fill in the Blanks

- i. The media often seek not only to inform, but also to _____ us.
- ii. A fact can be _____.
- iii. The tendency to favour one person, group or view-point over another is called _____.
- iv. The technique of using information to arouse feelings is called _____.
- v. When all women or all men are said to behave in a certain way, this is an example of _____.

2. Make a Table in column A, list the strategies used to provide incorrect or misleading information, in column B write the definition, and in column C give an example.

3. Answer the Following Questions

- i. Why is it important to be able to differentiate fact from opinion?
- ii. List the various forms of bias in the media and give an example of each.
- iii. Define the term 'stereotyping and its forms in Sindh.
- iv. Give three example of how women are stereotyped in Sindh.
- v. What is propaganda? How can it serve to help or harm a cause?
- vi. List the propaganda techniques and give an example of each.

B. Use Your Inquiry/Investigation Skills

1. The main aim of advertising is to motivate people to buy the product advertised. To do this, advertisements only shows one side, the good side. Identify the biases in at least four advertisements appeared in the magazine.

C. Cooperate With Others

1. Work in a small group and conduct an inquiry as directed in part B. Each of you should choose an advertisement and identify the biases in the advertisement. Work together and identify the requirements for making a fair advertisement.

END OF UNIT EXERCISE

A. Check Your Knowledge And Understanding

1. Match the Words in Column A to Their Definitions in Column B

COLUMN A	COLUMN B
Bias	Communication channels through which news and information, entertainment and education are spread.
Fact	Communication through social interaction.
Media	A statement about something that really happened and can be checked.
Propaganda	A tendency to favor one person, group or viewpoint over another, often in an unfair way.
Social Media	A systematic effort to spread opinions or beliefs, often by distortion and deception.

2. Answer the Following Questions

- What is the role of the media in society?
- How do the media promote the rights to freedom of expression and freedom of information?
- Why is it important to be aware of the ways the media can present inaccurate or misleading information?

B. Use Your Inquiry/Investigation Skills

- Interview media persons to find out in which media they are working? Does it promote democracy in Pakistan?

C. Communicate With Others

- Write a news report on an event in your school. Add a photograph with caption.

D. Cooperate With Others

- Develop an advertisement about selling chocolate/biscuits. One of you should perform as a seller and other should record it on a mobile phone and upload it on the internet.

E. Be Creative

1. Working in a pair together with a colleague, design an advertisement for TV. You should make a draw the product you want to advertise, give it a name and prepare a jingle that you will sing to sell your product.

F. Become Technologically Smart

1. Send the news report, written as a part of “Section C: communication with others” to the Principal, your teacher and classmates as an attachment to an email.

G. Take an Action for the Common Good

1. Teach someone in your family the different ways in which inaccurate and misleading information is presented in the media. Use lots of examples to help them to understand.